just, already, yet: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 16 (pages 42–43): *just, already, yet*. Do **16.1, 16.2** in class, **16.3, 16.4** at home. Unit 95 (pages 200–201): **95.3** on Day 3.
This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · Where do the words go?

just and **already**: **between have and the 3rd form** → *I've **just** arrived. She has **already** left.*
yet: **at the end** → *I haven't finished **yet**. Have you eaten **yet**?*
already can also go at the end for surprise: Have you finished already?

2 · Short answers

Have you finished? → **Yes, I've already finished.** / **Not yet.** / **Almost.** / **I've just finished!**
Has the bus come? — Not yet. Are you ready? — Already?! (= so early!)

3 · American English (your students will hear it)

In American English the past simple is common: *I **just ate**. Did you **eat yet**? I **already saw** that film.*
In British English: *I've just eaten. Have you eaten yet?* Both are correct; in exams and in the book use the **present perfect**.

4 · yet or still?

yet: waiting for something → *He hasn't come **yet**.*
still: the situation continues → *He is **still** waiting. I **still** haven't finished.*
Murphy Unit 95 has still / yet / already together: use it on Day 3.

5 · The Russian trap

«Ты уже поел?» → *Have you eaten **yet**?* (question: yet) «Я уже поел.» → *I've **already** eaten.* (positive: already)
«Я только что пришёл» → *I've **just** arrived.* (not ✗ I just now came)
Russian uses «уже» for all three. English chooses already / yet / just.

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 just, already or yet? Write the word

1. I've ____ finished my homework. I can go out now.
2. Have you cleaned your room ____?
3. It's only nine o'clock and she has ____ gone to bed.
4. He hasn't called me ____.
5. We've ____ arrived: we are at the hotel now.
6. Have you seen this film ____? It is great.
7. I've ____ eaten, thanks. I'm not hungry.
8. Has the plane landed ____?

2 Make sentences with the words in brackets

1. (I / just / buy / a new phone) ____
2. (she / already / finish / the book) ____
3. (they / not / arrive / yet) ____
4. (you / do / the shopping / yet?) ____
5. (we / just / see / a good film) ____
6. (he / already / leave) ____

3 Translate into English

1. Я только что пришёл домой.

2. Ты уже сделал уроки?

3. Они ещё не приехали.

4. Она уже ушла.

5. Мы уже поели.

6. Автобус ещё не пришёл.

7. Я ещё не решил.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Write your list for the weekend: what have you done, what have you not done yet?

Write 8 sentences: *I have already done my homework. I haven't cleaned my room yet. I've just...* Use just, already and yet at least twice each.

5 Complete the dialogue

A: (1 you / finish) _____ your project **yet**?

B: No, I (2 not / finish) _____ it **yet**. I (3 just / start) _____ the last part.

A: (4 you / arrange) _____ the meeting?

B: Yes, I (5 already / arrange) _____ it: it is on Friday.

A: (6 Ali / accept) _____ the invitation **yet**? B: He (7 just / call) _____ me: he can come. A: Great! And the teacher? B: She (8 already / say) _____ yes. A: (9 you / buy) _____ the tickets **yet**? B: No, I (10 not / buy) _____ them **yet**.

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 just · yet · already · yet · just · yet (or already) · just (or already) · yet

2 I've just bought a new phone. · She has already finished the book. · They haven't arrived yet. · Have you done the shopping yet? · We've just seen a good film. · He has already left.

3 I've just come home. · Have you done your homework yet? · They haven't arrived yet. · She has already left. · We've already eaten. · The bus hasn't come yet. · I haven't decided yet.

4 Own answers.

5 Have you finished · haven't finished · have just started · Have you arranged · have already arranged · Has Ali accepted · has just called · has already said · Have you bought · haven't bought